AI Guardrails

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1. Purpose

This page states the rules for the AI part of the tool. The Claude API writes a short executive summary. The AI never sets the ticket status or the project status. Rules in the code set them (D02).

2. Data that goes to the AI

Data	Reason
Weekly numbers (closed, opened, open, blocked, overdue)	The summary describes progress.
The priority matrix	The summary describes where the problems are.
The project status and its reason	The summary explains the status. It does not change it.
For each ticket that is not green, and each ticket closed this week: key, P-level (P1 to P5 or Unmapped), ticket status, and days blocked (D35)	The summary can name the important tickets and say why they matter. Green tickets are only in the counts, so the input stays small for big projects.
Ticket titles (only when the hide option is off)	The summary is easier to read with titles.

3. Data that never goes to the AI

- Ticket descriptions and comments (D03)
- Assignee names, reporter names, and email addresses (D28)
- API keys, tokens, and any other secrets
- Ticket titles, when `hide_titles_from_ai` is true in config.yaml (D25)

Why assignee names stay out: names are personal data, and the summary does not need them. The full report still shows the owner of each ticket. Only the AI input leaves out the names.

4. Rules for the summary

Rule	Reason
Use only the facts in the input.	Prevents facts that are not true.
Do not change or question the status.	The rules set the status (D02).
Name only ticket keys that are in the input.	Prevents tickets that do not exist.
Write 3 to 5 sentences, then a "Next week" list.	An executive reads it in less than one minute.
Start with "The project is <status>." Do not use "not" or "no longer" with the status word.	The reader sees the rule status first, in the same words (D41).
If the status is not Green, do not use "on track", "healthy", "no risks", "no concerns", "no issues", or "all good".	These words soften a Red or Amber status (D44).
Write in plain, neutral words. No blame on a person.	The report is for the whole team.

5. Checks in the code

1. The tool sends the input as structured data, with the rules in the prompt. The call uses structured outputs (output_config with a JSON schema: summary, next_week), so the API returns JSON in this form. Claude Sonnet 5.5 refuses a forced tool call, so the tool does not use one (D49, D50).
2. The tool reads the summary and finds each ticket key in it.
3. If a key is not in the input, the tool removes the summary and shows a warning.
4. The tool also removes the summary, and shows a warning, if the answer is not in the agreed form, does not have 3 to 5 sentences, or does not have 1 to 5 "Next week" items (D36). The warning states the reason: no JSON object, the JSON error and its position, a missing field, an answer cut at the output limit, a refusal, or the API status and message (D49, D50).
5. The tool removes the summary if the first sentence does not state the project status from the rules, if a word such as "not", "no longer", or "rather than" comes before the status word, or if the summary gives the project a different status (D41).
6. For a project that is not Green, the tool removes the summary if any sentence or Next week item has "on track", "healthy", "no risks", "no concerns", "no issues", or "all good" (D44).
7. The report always shows the status and the numbers from the rules, never from the AI.
8. Each AI change also runs once on real data before Review. Real data finds cases that the samples do not have, for example quotes in titles (L15).

6. AI evaluation set

The evaluation set measures the quality of the summary (D12). It runs before an AI ticket goes to Review, and after each change to the prompt, the model, or the API call (L14). For a failed sample, it prints what the AI wrote (D44). It has 6 sample weeks. At v1.0.0, all 6 pass.

Sample week	The summary must contain	The summary must not contain
Red week	The red status and the P1 or P2 ticket that causes it	A green or positive status
Amber week	The amber status and its reason	Tickets that are not in the input
Green week	The green status and the closed count	Risks that are not in the input
Empty week	"No open tickets" or the same meaning	Made-up work or progress
Hidden titles	Ticket keys only	Any ticket title
Quotes and braces in titles	The red status and the P1 ticket; the answer keeps its form	A green or positive status, "not Red" (SRG-40)

7. Cost and failure

- config.yaml sets a maximum number of tokens for each run: 8000, input and output (D25, D37). The answer can use at most 2000 tokens, for thinking and text together. The thinking effort is low, because a summary of facts needs little thinking (D51). The tool estimates the tokens before the call and makes no call above the limit.
- The model name is in config.yaml.
- If the AI fails, times out, or goes over the limit, the tool makes the full report without the summary and shows a warning.
- With `--no-ai`, the tool makes no call to the AI.

8. Related decisions

D02, D03, D12, D25, D27, D28, D35, D36, D37, D41, D44, D49, D50, D51. See the Decision Log.